THE PROSPERITY PROJECT

Learning gains. A clearer picture of impact.

Impact report | Assessment findings | October 2026

420
total learner records
Four institutional cohorts

368
complete matched pairs
Same learners before and after

+28.73 pp
average score change
51.71% PRE to 80.43% POST

Executive summary

The Prosperity Project's reconciled dataset contains **420 total learner records**: 200 from Kolhapur, 70 from Shristi, 110 from FEED and 40 from Bandhan-Konnagar. Among **368 learners with complete matched PRE and POST assessments**, the average score rose from **51.71% to 80.43%**, a gain of **28.73 percentage points** (95% confidence interval: 25.32 to 32.14). This is an increase of 2.01 correct answers on a seven-question assessment.

Progress was broad, but not universal. 262 learners improved (71.2%), 52 were unchanged (14.1%) and 54 declined (14.7%). The median learner gained two correct answers.

Starting points matter. FEED had the largest average gain and the lowest baseline. Bandhan-Konnagar began highest and gained 18.42 points. All four cohort mean gains were positive. High baseline scorers had less room to improve.

Every available answer contributes. Question-level comparisons use **391-399 matched answers per item**, retaining usable responses from partial assessments. Monthly interest showed the largest gain, **39.60 points**. Budgeting and UPI safety had the lowest POST accuracy.

Measurement was examined alongside learning. Excluding S05 gives a gain of **30.30 points for the same 368 learners**. A separately eligible 371-person six-item sample gives 30.01 points. The original Asansol case also shows why wording checks and clear denominators matter. Seven-item scores remain primary.

These findings describe recorded PRE/POST test performance. They do not establish lasting behavioural change. This reconciled edition explains its populations, calculations and scope on pages 10-12.

01 / REACH AND MEASUREMENT

420 learner records. Every available answer counts.

The workbook records financial-literacy activity associated with Indo Count in Kolhapur, Shristi Corp and FEED in Asansol, and Bandhan-Konnagar in Baruipur. The assessment covers budgeting, deposits, borrowing costs, scam protection, emergency savings, diversification and UPI safety.

Programme metadata lists Shristi and FEED delivery as online. These comparisons use **institutional cohorts**; record totals are not a count of individual workshops or teaching hours.

Cohort	Learner records	Complete PRE	Complete POST	Matched pairs	Pair coverage
Indo Count, Kolhapur	200	190	181	172	86.0%
Shristi Corp, Asansol	70	66	62	59	84.3%
FEED, Asansol	110	106	103	99	90.0%
Bandhan-Konnagar, Baruipur	40	40	38	38	95.0%
All cohorts	420	402	384	368	87.6%

Table 1. All 420 records. Complete PRE and POST counts can include different learners. The 368 complete pairs support overall within-learner score change. Assessment counts must not be added together as distinct people.

What learners brought to the programme

Baseline self-report	YES	Valid answers	Share YES
Saves in most months	347	417	83.2%
Bank account in own name	411	418	98.3%
Has used a Fixed or Recurring Deposit	104	418	24.9%

Table 2. Each unscored context question uses every valid answer. C01 has 3 missing responses; C02 and C03 each have 2. These are baseline descriptions, not programme outcomes.

Bank-account ownership was widespread (98.3%), while previous deposit use was less common (24.9%). This supports teaching appropriate use of financial tools alongside access and safety.

Fifty-two records lack a complete seven-question pair: 17 have no scored POST answers, 19 have a partial POST, and 16 have a complete POST with an incomplete PRE. Their valid answers still contribute to question-level analysis. Missing answers are not scored as wrong.

02 / OVERALL OUTCOMES

A strong average gain, with variation between learners.

3.62 → 5.63
mean score out of 7
Same 368 learners

+2.01
mean correct-answer gain
95% CI: +1.77 to +2.25

+2
median score change
Observed range: -4 to +7

The average gain of **28.73 percentage points** has a 95% confidence interval of **25.32 to 32.14 points**. It measures change on a seven-question assessment, rather than a percentage increase in saving or financial wellbeing.

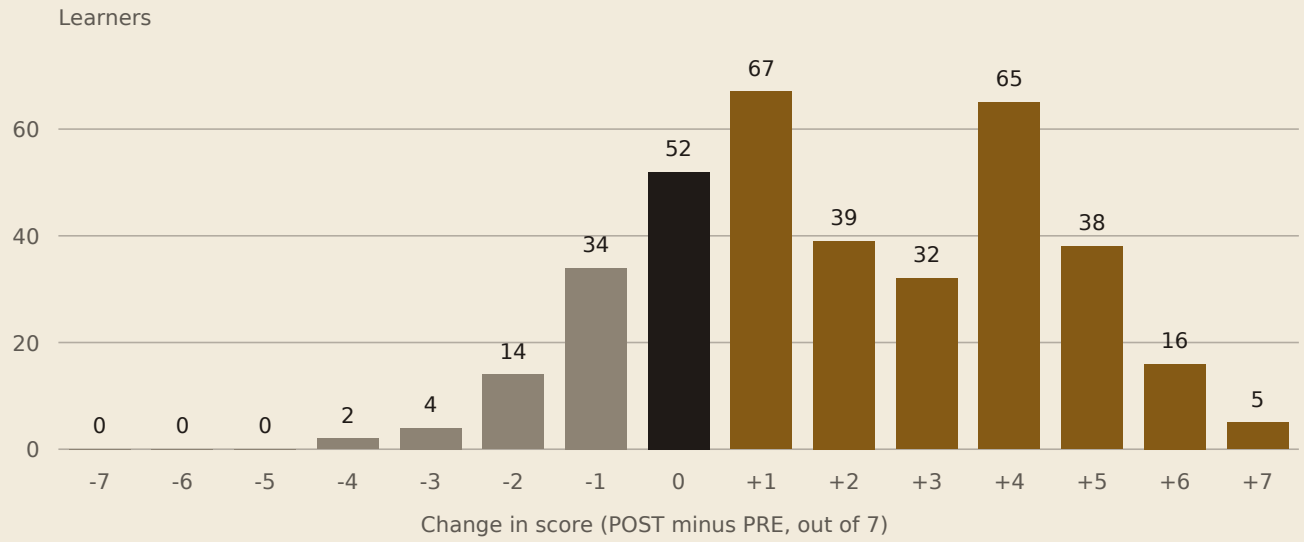


Figure 1. POST minus PRE scores for the same 368 complete matched learners. Counts are shown above bars. All gains, ties and declines remain in the calculation.

Outcome	Learners	Share of matched pairs
Improved	262	71.2%
Unchanged	52	14.1%
Declined	54	14.7%

A positive mean does not describe every learner. Just under three in ten had no increase, and 54 scored lower at POST. An unchanged total can conceal gains on some concepts and losses on others.

A paired t-test and an exact sign test both give p<.001. The sign test compares 262 gains with 54 declines, excluding 52 ties. The standardized paired change is d_z=0.86. These cross-checks support the recorded pattern without establishing causation.

03 / DIFFERENCES BETWEEN COHORTS

The starting point matters when reading a gain.

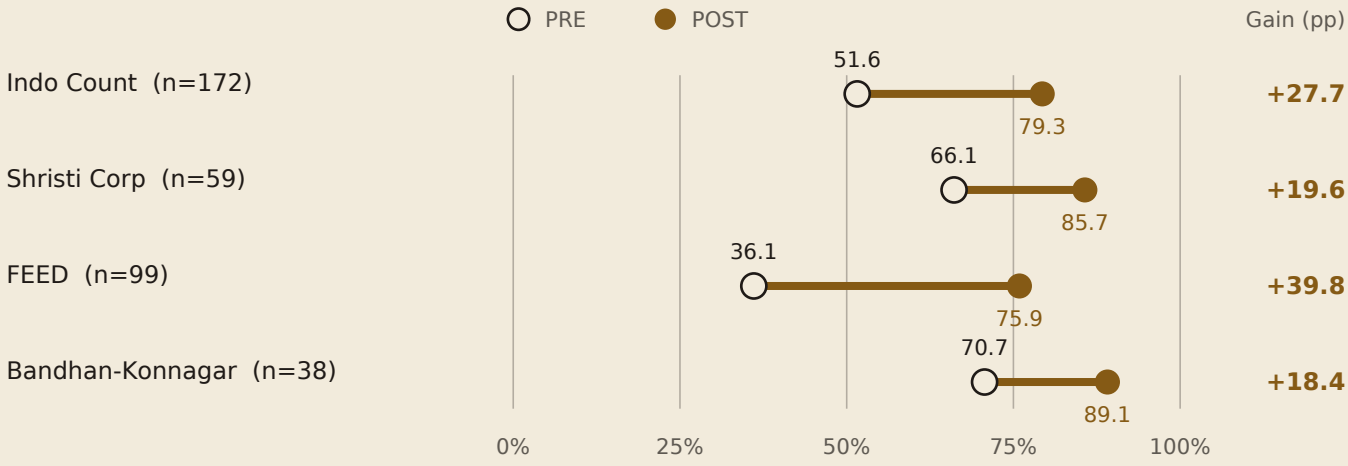


Figure 2. Mean PRE and POST scores for the same learners within each cohort. The scale is percentage correct; sample sizes appear beside cohort names.

Cohort	Pairs	Gain (pp)	95% CI (pp)	Improved / same / declined
Indo Count	172	+27.74	21.99 to 33.49	113 / 22 / 37
Shristi	59	+19.61	13.28 to 25.94	41 / 10 / 8
FEED	99	+39.83	33.88 to 45.77	80 / 13 / 6
Bandhan-Konnagar	38	+18.42	11.88 to 24.96	28 / 7 / 3

Table 3. Unadjusted paired t confidence intervals. Cohort differences describe outcomes and starting knowledge; they do not isolate delivery quality. pp means percentage points.

FEED: the largest increase, +39.83 points (n=99), accompanied the lowest baseline, 36.08%. Eighty learners improved and six declined. Its greater room to improve matters when interpreting this result.

Indo Count: 172 complete pairs increased from 51.58% to 79.32%, a gain of 27.74 points. It also contained 37 declines (21.5% of its matched learners). Its progress and uneven outcomes both shape the pooled result.

Shristi: the full 59-pair cohort gained 19.61 points, from 66.10% to 85.71%. This broader cohort is distinct from the original session linked to the S05 concern, examined on page 8.

Bandhan-Konnagar: 38 pairs began highest, at 70.68%, and reached 89.10%. Its 18.42-point gain has a 95% confidence interval of 11.88 to 24.96 points. The reconciled cohort includes 40 total records.

04 / DIFFERENCES BETWEEN LEARNERS

Starting scores reveal different learner experiences.

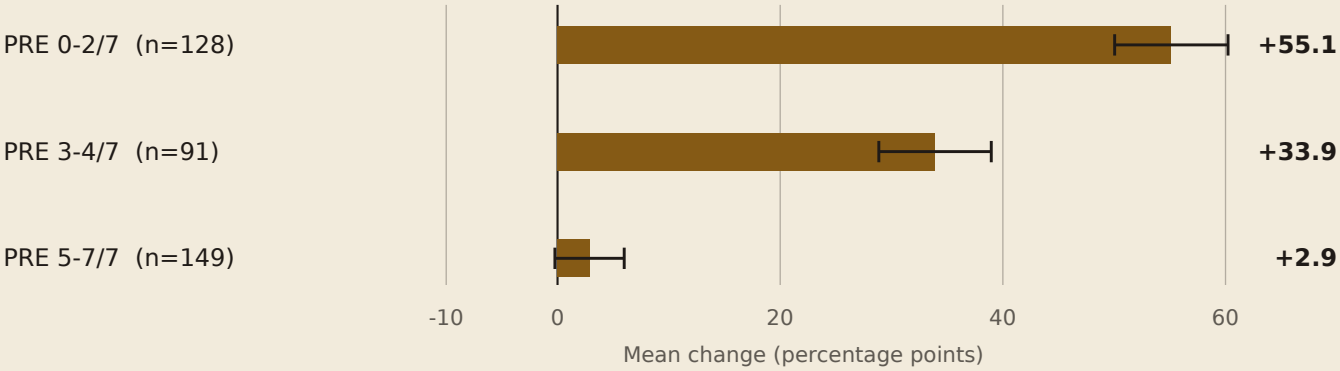


Figure 3. Mean change by PRE score band, n=368 overall. Lines show exploratory, unadjusted 95% paired t intervals. These descriptive bands were created for this analysis.

PRE score (out of 7)	Pairs	Mean PRE → POST (out of 7)	Improved / same / declined
0-2	128	1.27 → 5.12	112 / 9 / 7
3-4	91	3.38 → 5.76	76 / 10 / 5
5-7	149	5.79 → 5.99	74 / 33 / 42

Table 4. Each row compares the same learners. In the 0-2 band, 112/128 improved. In the 5-7 band, 74/149 improved and 42 declined.

What the pattern supports. Learners starting with 0-2 correct answers gained 3.86 answers on average. Those starting with 5-7 averaged a smaller increase of 0.20 answers; its confidence interval includes zero. One overall gain conceals different learner experiences.

How to read the difference. High scorers have less room to rise on a seven-item test. Grouping by PRE scores also introduces regression to the mean: unusually low or high scores can move toward typical values on retesting. These bands do not prove that the programme works better for one type of learner.

A practical response

Use a short baseline check to vary practice and challenge. Add harder applications for learners who already know the basics.

At POST, 162/368 learners (44.0%) scored 7/7, compared with 24/368 (6.5%) at PRE. This ceiling limits detection of further progress. The workbook does not provide a basis for comparisons by age, gender or income.

05 / CONCEPTS

Interest costs became clearer. Budgeting needs more practice.

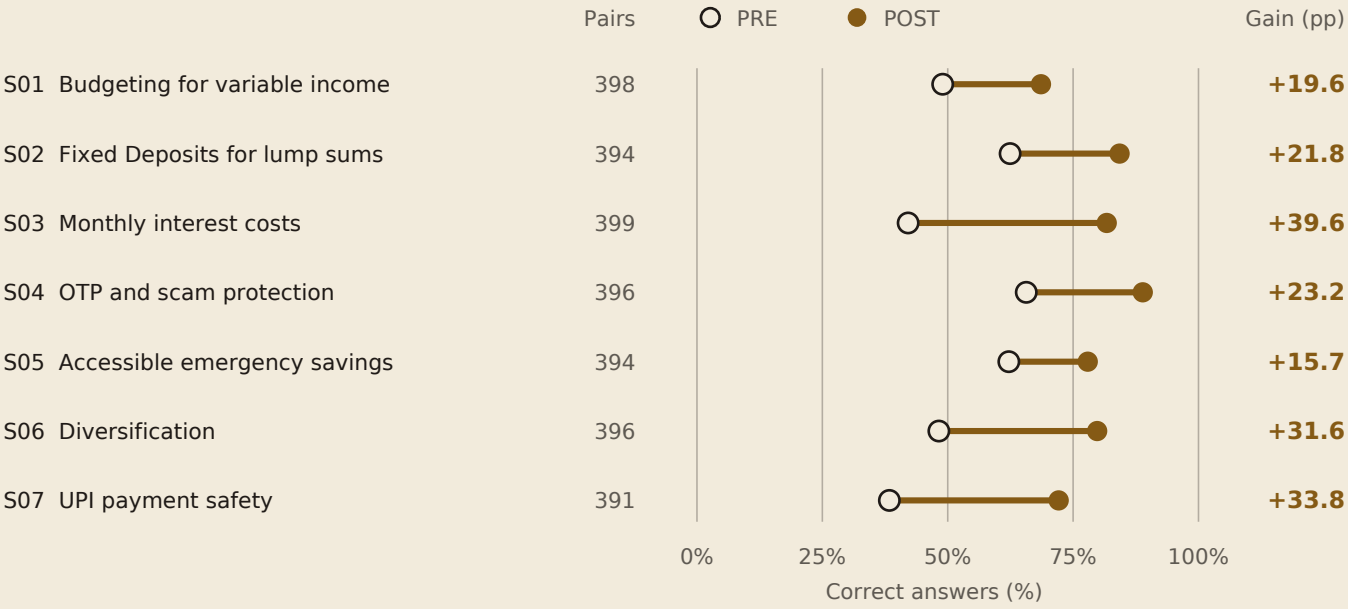


Figure 4. Every valid PRE/POST pair for each question is included, even when other answers are missing. Sample sizes range from 391 to 399. All seven net changes are positive; each question also has correct-to-incorrect transitions.

Monthly interest (S03) rose from 42.11% to 81.70% correct: 173 learners moved from incorrect to correct and 15 moved the other way (n=399). **OTP protection (S04)** had the highest POST accuracy, 88.89% (n=396).

Budgeting (S01) ended at 68.59% correct, with 125/398 still incorrect. **UPI safety (S07)** ended at 72.12%, with 109/391 incorrect. Both warrant more practice despite positive gains.

Concept gains also differ between cohorts

Cohort	S01	S02	S03	S04	S05	S06	S07
Indo Count	+7.9 (n=190)	+18.1 (n=188)	+39.7 (n=189)	+23.7 (n=186)	+6.5 (n=186)	+38.1 (n=189)	+35.3 (n=184)
Shristi	+24.2 (n=66)	+11.1 (n=63)	+36.4 (n=66)	+16.7 (n=66)	+10.9 (n=64)	+10.8 (n=65)	+14.3 (n=63)
FEED	+43.1 (n=102)	+35.0 (n=103)	+49.0 (n=104)	+30.8 (n=104)	+39.0 (n=105)	+33.0 (n=103)	+45.2 (n=104)
Bandhan-Konnagar	+7.5 (n=40)	+22.5 (n=40)	+20.0 (n=40)	+12.5 (n=40)	+5.1 (n=39)	+30.8 (n=39)	+27.5 (n=40)

Table 5. Net accuracy change in percentage points. Every cell shows its own paired sample size. Concept codes match Figure 4. These are descriptive comparisons across different groups of learners.

06 / S05 SENSITIVITY

Keep the primary result. Test what the question changes.

S05 tests accessible emergency savings. A documented wording concern prompted an alternative calculation with S05 excluded from **both PRE and POST**. The main analysis retains all seven questions. The six-item analysis measures a narrower set of concepts.

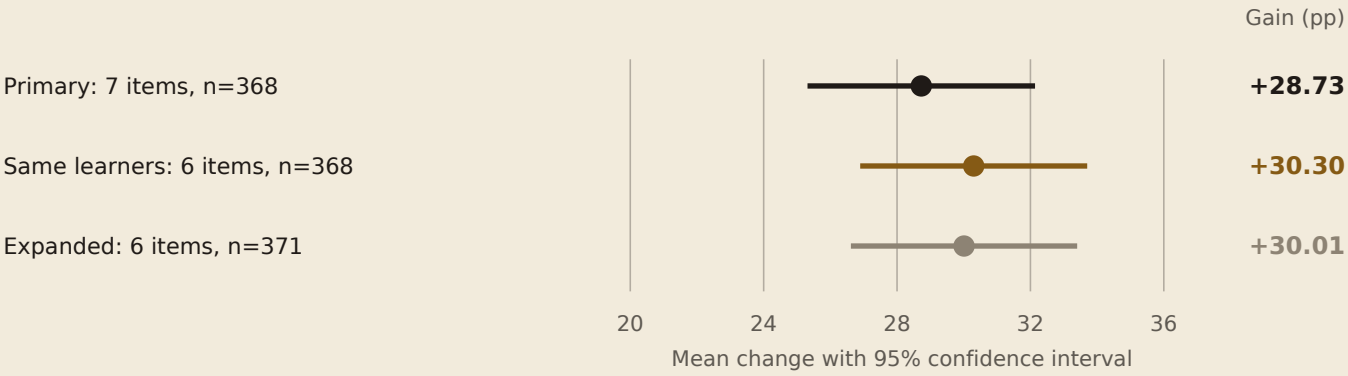


Figure 5. The first two estimates compare the same 368 learners. The third uses a separately eligible 371-person sample. Lines show 95% paired t intervals; the chart scale begins at 20 points.

Same learners, different assessment. For the 368 complete pairs, six-item scores rose from **50.18% to 80.48%**, a gain of **30.30 points** (95% CI: 26.90 to 33.70). This is 1.57 points above the seven-item gain of 28.73.

Expanded eligibility. Three additional learners had complete answers to the six retained questions but no POST S05 answer. This gives **371 six-item pairs**: 50.45% PRE to 80.46% POST, a gain of **30.01 points** (95% CI: 26.62 to 33.40). The additions are two Kolhapur learners and one Bandhan learner.

Cohort	Same pairs	7-item gain (pp)	6-item gain (pp)	Expanded 6-item n	Expanded gain (pp)
All learners	368	+28.73	+30.30	371	+30.01
Indo Count	172	+27.74	+30.52	174	+30.08
Shristi	59	+19.61	+20.34	59	+20.34
FEED	99	+39.83	+39.56	99	+39.56
Bandhan-Konnagar	38	+18.42	+20.61	39	+20.09

Table 6. Same-pair comparisons retain each cohort’s seven-item complete learners. Expanded samples require complete answers only to the six retained questions. Six-item percentages divide by 6; seven-item percentages divide by 7.

Omitting S05 does not increase every cohort’s percentage gain: FEED changes from +39.83 to +39.56 points for the same 99 learners. The main pooled gain remains positive under either specification.

07 / MEASUREMENT IN PRACTICE

S05: examine the wording as well as the score.

The workbook records a Green POST S05 comprehension concern in the original 14-person Shristi session. Among its **12 learners with usable S05 answers at both stages**, correct answers fell from **12/12 to 5/12**. The question asks whether a long, locked Fixed Deposit is the best place for all emergency savings; the keyed answer is NO.

The original Asansol subgroup provides **24 complete matched assessments: nine from Shristi and 15 from FEED**. Its seven-item gain was **3.57 points** (95% CI: -2.39 to +9.54). Excluding S05 increased the estimated gain to **7.64 points** (95% CI: +2.16 to +13.12). These records remain part of the unified population.

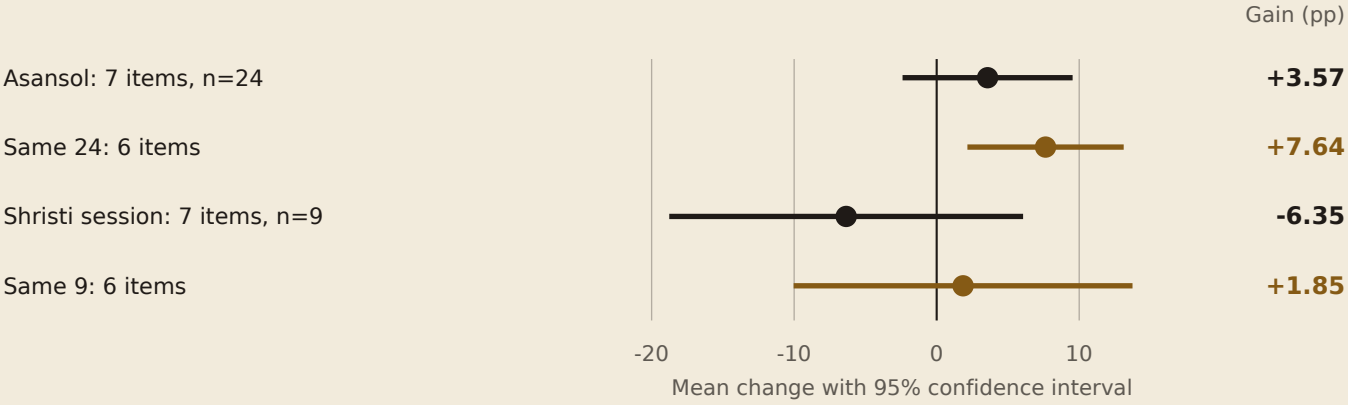


Figure 6. The same learners are retained within each seven-versus-six comparison. The original Asansol subgroup is a subset of the full institutional cohorts. Subgroup intervals are exploratory and unadjusted.

Shristi alone (n=9) changed from **-6.35 points** across seven items to **+1.85 points** across six. Both confidence intervals include zero. All 15 FEED learners in this original subgroup answered S05 correctly at both stages, so their percentage gain increases when the retained improvement is expressed out of six rather than seven.

The pooled Asansol change reflects **both** removing S05's negative contribution in Shristi and changing the scoring denominator. It does not establish that learning doubled or that wording caused the difference. The recorded concern justifies investigating comprehension while keeping the original score visible.

S05 also declined in the original Kolhapur records: among **88 learners** with paired answers, correct responses fell from **86 to 53**. Across the full reconciled Kolhapur item sample, accuracy increased from **67.20% to 73.66% (n=186)**. Subgroup and full-cohort results can differ; both are retained without assigning an unsupported cause.

08 / LESSONS FOR FUTURE DELIVERY

Turn the patterns into a better next round.

The findings suggest practical changes in teaching and measurement. These are recommendations, rather than claims about changes already implemented.

What we learned	Evidence	Next delivery decision
Budgeting and UPI safety need practice.	At POST, 125/398 answered budgeting incorrectly and 109/391 answered UPI safety incorrectly.	Use short scenarios, learner explanations and fresh examples. Recheck understanding after practice.
High starters need more challenge.	The 5-7 PRE band (n=149) averaged +0.20 answers; 44.0% of all pairs reached 7/7 at POST.	Keep common core questions and add harder application tasks to detect deeper learning.
Some learners need follow-through.	54/368 declined, including 37/172 at Indo Count.	Examine concept reversals and gather neutral feedback about wording, pace and assessment conditions.
S05 needs comprehension testing.	In the original Asansol subgroup (n=24), the gain changes from +3.57 to +7.64 points without S05.	Pilot wording and translations with learner explanations. Record the version actually used.
Partial forms still hold information.	52/420 lack complete pairs; question-level samples reach 391-399.	Check missing responses at collection without coaching answers. Preserve every usable answer.
Longer-term outcomes remain open.	The results reported here are PRE/POST test scores.	Add consistently timed follow-up and consented measures of applied knowledge and behaviour.

Table 7. Recommendations tied to observed findings. Individual declines prompt investigation rather than an assumed explanation.

Make the next comparison more informative

Record dates, attendance, language, administration mode and instrument version alongside each assessment. Preserve entry corrections transparently and plan any comparison group before delivery. This would help distinguish delivery differences from starting knowledge, measurement and timing.

A stronger next round would examine whether learners retain and use what the assessment measures.

APPENDIX A / METHODS

How the findings were calculated.

Source and population. The reconciled **Data Master spreadsheet** was the sole numerical source. It contains the project's recorded paper-questionnaire answers. Completed Summary calculations and reporting definitions were used, then checked against the 420 canonical records and their recorded scoring fields. Historical tabs were not used to build an alternative population.

Reconciliation. This edition uses the reconciled master dataset. Cohort allocations and response-selection rules have been standardised, and complete-assessment results are distinguished from question-level results, which retain usable answers from partial assessments. Earlier drafts used different record versions and denominators. This edition replaces their numerical findings with the reconciled workbook's results.

Scoring and eligibility. S01-S07 receive one point for each answer matching the **recorded form colour's** key, giving 0-7. Most records use BLUE PRE and GREEN POST; ten use the reverse route. C01-C03 are unscored. Missing answers stay missing. Complete score changes require seven valid answers at both stages (n=368). Individual questions retain all valid matched answers for that item (n=391-399).

Primary estimate. Each learner's change is POST minus PRE. The mean averages those differences, weighting learners equally. Percentage-point change is 100 × mean change ÷ 7. PRE and POST means use the same 368 learners. Context questions use all valid responses, each with its own denominator.

Overall statistic	Value	Interpretation
Matched pairs	368	Same learners before and after
Mean change; SD of change	2.011; 2.330	Correct answers out of 7
Paired t-test	t(367)=16.56; p<.001	Tests zero mean recorded change
Exact sign test	262 gains; 54 declines; p<.001	Excludes 52 ties
Paired effect size d_z	0.86	Mean change / SD of changes

Statistical checks. A 95% interval is mean change ± $t_{0.975,n-1}$ × SD(change)/√n. A 10,000-resample learner bootstrap (seed 20261017) gives a similar overall interval: +25.31 to +32.18 points. Exact two-sided McNemar tests compare wrong-to-correct with correct-to-wrong item transitions; Holm adjustment covers seven questions. Item-change intervals use paired differences of -1, 0 or +1.

S05 sensitivity. Exclude S05 from both stages and divide by six. The principal sensitivity retains the same 368 learners. Expanded eligibility adds three learners missing only POST S05 (n=371). That different sample is not used to isolate the effect of omitting S05. The workbook's separate follow-up measure omits S06, not S05.

APPENDIX B / QUESTION DETAIL

Use every answer.
Keep the comparison clear.

Item	Pairs	PRE → POST correct	Change (pp) 95% CI	Wrong → correct	Correct → wrong	Adjusted p
S01	398	195 → 273	+19.60 (13.33 to 25.87)	127	49	<.001
S02	394	246 → 332	+21.83 (16.75 to 26.90)	104	18	<.001
S03	399	168 → 326	+39.60 (34.07 to 45.12)	173	15	<.001
S04	396	260 → 352	+23.23 (18.15 to 28.32)	109	17	<.001
S05	394	245 → 307	+15.74 (9.49 to 21.98)	114	52	<.001
S06	396	191 → 316	+31.57 (26.27 to 36.86)	139	14	<.001
S07	391	150 → 282	+33.76 (27.90 to 39.62)	156	24	<.001

Table A1. Matched question-level comparisons. Each row retains the same learners at PRE and POST. All seven exact McNemar p-values remain below .001 after Holm adjustment. Confidence intervals are unadjusted paired t intervals.

All available answers, including one-sided records

Item	PRE correct / available	POST correct / available
S01	203/417 (48.68%)	275/401 (68.58%)
S02	260/417 (62.35%)	334/396 (84.34%)
S03	173/417 (41.49%)	327/402 (81.34%)
S04	266/414 (64.25%)	357/402 (88.81%)
S05	255/415 (61.45%)	308/398 (77.39%)
S06	199/416 (47.84%)	318/400 (79.50%)
S07	159/413 (38.50%)	285/398 (71.61%)

Table A2. These snapshots use every valid answer at each stage, including answers without a counterpart. PRE and POST populations differ. They are not used to calculate within-learner gains.

S01 budgeting; S02 deposits; S03 monthly interest; S04 OTP protection; S05 emergency savings; S06 diversification; S07 UPI safety. Calculations use unrounded values, so displayed percentages may not subtract exactly to the reported change.

APPENDIX C / SCOPE AND SOURCES

What the evidence supports.

What these results establish. The findings describe recorded PRE/POST test performance. The workbook provides no comparison group or usable delayed follow-up for these results, so they cannot establish lasting learning, changed financial behaviour, or how much of the change was caused by the workshops.

Assessment coverage. Overall score changes use 368 learners with complete PRE and POST assessments. The other 52 records contribute wherever their answers are available. Each question uses everyone with valid PRE and POST answers to that question, so sample sizes vary from 391 to 399. These groups are not identical and may not represent every learner equally.

Basis of the checks. The numerical checks verify internal agreement between recorded answers, scoring and reporting tables in the reconciled spreadsheet. They do not constitute independent field verification.

Statistical scope. The seven-item assessment is brief and PRE/POST wording differs. Confidence intervals assume independent learners and do not account for shared workshop conditions or measurement bias. Differences between cohorts and starting-score groups are descriptive, rather than proof that one delivery approach works better.

Interpreting S05. Removing S05 narrows the assessment from seven concepts to six. The main sensitivity comparisons retain the same learners. The separately eligible 371-person sample has a different population. The stronger six-item result for the original Asansol subgroup does not establish that wording caused the difference. Shristi’s original nine-pair subgroup remains statistically inconclusive.

Among the 52 records without complete pairs, 34 had complete PRE scores averaging 3.79/7, compared with 3.62/7 among the complete pairs. Reasons for missingness are not established. Subgroup intervals are exploratory and unadjusted.

Source locations in the reconciled spreadsheet. Population and selected responses: Data Master A1:AG421. Scored responses, eligibility, recorded colours and subgroup labels: Record Details A1:DP421. Completed outputs: Summary A7:M137. Scoring keys: Internal Scoring Key A5:D11. Wording: Question Specification A5:I22. S05 concern: Sessions row 2 and README row 16. The original Asansol and Kolhapur subgroup examples use the reconciled records labelled A/B, without substituting responses from historical sheets.